

Afnan Alabdulwahab

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EDUCATION

Jun 2024 – May 2025	University of Virginia Charlottesville, VA Master of Science in Data Science Relevant Coursework: Ethics of Big Data, Bayesian ML, Deep Learning, Decoding LLMs, GPU Architectures
Aug 2012 – May 2017	Old Dominion University Norfolk, VA Bachelor of Science in Electrical Engineering, Minor in Applied Mathematics Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering, Minor in Computer Science

PROJECTS

- PRISM AI Safety Research Fellowship: Interpretability for Scientific Causal Reasoning** | Jun 2026 – Sep 2026
- Began literature review of causal inference and interpretability methods on confounding in LLM experiments and probe generalizability
 - Explored the PXR drug toxicity benchmark dataset and experimental design, mapping causal inference concepts (intervention, confounding, negative controls) to the fellowship's interpretability evaluation setup
- [UVA Capstone: LLM Evaluation Research \(Deloitte-Anthropic Collaboration\)](#)** | Oct 2024 – May 2025
- AI Safety, Responsible AI, Python, LLMs, NLP, Bias Datasets, RAGAS, promptfoo, DeepEval, TruLens, Empath, Stanford CoreNLP, LLM-as-a-Judge*
- Led bias detection research stream in Deloitte-sponsored capstone project, designing comprehensive evaluation methodology comparing LLM-as-a-Judge frameworks against traditional NLP methods across 8 key metrics including bias, toxicity, and hallucination detection
 - Implemented multi-dataset bias evaluation pipeline using WinoBias and CrowS-Pairs datasets to assess gender bias and social bias detection across 9 demographic categories (race, gender, religion, etc.)
 - Implemented counterfactual testing framework measuring LLM response consistency when sensitive attributes were altered
 - Co-authored research paper and delivered interactive leaderboard to guide responsible LLM evaluation framework selection
- [Benchmarking GPU Matrix Operations Optimizations](#)** | Feb 2025 – May 2025
- C++, CUDA, Python, CUTLASS, cuBLAS, CuTe, Tensor Cores, NVIDIA Nsight Systems, GPU Profiling Tools, Optimization, Parallel Programming*
- Implemented and benchmarked CUDA kernels for matrix transpose optimization across NVIDIA RTX 2080 Ti (Turing) and A100 (Ampere) GPUs, exploring opportunities to reduce latency and improve GPU resource utilization for transformer-based models
 - Developed and benchmarked custom CUDA implementations (naive, shared memory tiling, swizzled indexing, vectorized float4, warp shuffle) against cuBLAS, CUTLASS, and CuTe
 - Analyzed throughput, memory bandwidth, and access patterns across matrix sizes (32x32 to 8192x8192)

EXPERIENCE

- Emerson Automation Solutions (Acquired from GE) | Charlottesville, VA**
- Senior Software Engineer/Product Owner** | Jan 2022 – Jun 2022
- Acted as individual contributor (IC) and Product Owner of Emerson's PLC programmer (PME), focusing on creating and managing product backlogs, crafting detailed user stories, guiding developers, and delivering production software
 - Collaborated with cross-functional teams to define and translate high-level requirements into detailed user stories and actionable plans
 - Optimized hardware configuration performance through implementing solutions (C++) for power management issues
 - Enhanced team collaboration and productivity through leadership in Agile processes and backlog refinement
- Senior Software Engineer** | Jun 2021 – Dec 2021
- Led support development for configuring new PACSystems Controllers in a 14M-line legacy COM-based desktop application (C, C++, C#)
 - Provided mentorship, guidance, and pair programming to new team members, contributing to their successful onboarding and growth
 - Communicated progress and technical concepts to stakeholders and team leads, improving transparency and alignment
- Firmware Engineer** | Sep 2019 – Jun 2021
- Developed low-level (C/C++) firmware for real-time embedded systems for the PACSystems controllers using WindRiver's VxWorks RTOS
 - Collaborated across engineering teams to debug and resolve complex cross-stack firmware issues that spanned multiple system layers
- GE Automation & Controls | Charlottesville, VA**
- Software Engineer** | Jan 2018 – Sep 2019

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, R, C++, C#, C, SQL, CUDA, Hardware Description (VHDL), Assembly

Libraries and Frameworks: Tidyverse, Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, PyTorch, scikit-learn, HuggingFace Transformers

Development Tools and Methodologies: VxWorks RTOS, Git, VS Code, Jupyter Lab, RStudio, CICD, Agile, Scrum, SAFe

Machine Learning: Regression, Penalized Regression, Classification, Clustering, Decision Trees, Random Forest, Boosting, Support Vector Machines

Statistical Analysis: Resampling Methods, Bayesian Statistics, Probabilistic Programming (Stan/brms), Statistical Modeling, Inferential Statistics

Large Language Models: Transformer Models (RoBERTa), Tokenization, Parameter-Efficient Fine-tuning (LoRA)

AI Safety: LLM Safety Assessment, Bias and Fairness Evaluation, Safety Guardrails Evaluation, Evaluation Frameworks, Counterfactual Testing

Courses: BlueDot Impact - AGI strategy (Apr 2026), Technical AI Safety (Jun 2026)